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VentureX — Problem Statements

PS 1 — Kirana Stores vs Quick Commerce

Quick commerce platforms — Blinkit, Zepto, and Instamart — have captured significant urban grocery share, but even in FY26 they range from roughly breaking even to losing ₹75–85 per order, a model still substantially propped up by investor capital. Meanwhile, India's roughly 13 million kirana stores, which account for close to 90% of the country's grocery and FMCG sales, have local trust, informal credit relationships, and zero delivery cost — yet are steadily losing footfall, with retailer associations attributing close to 200,000 store closures over the past two years to this competition. Propose a business model that lets kiranas compete profitably — not by copying quick commerce's model, but by monetizing what they have that quick commerce doesn't: hyperlocal trust, credit relationships, and zero last-mile cost.

PS 2 — Restructuring the Agricultural Value Chain

Indian farmers typically realize only 30–37% of the final retail price of fruits and vegetables, with middlemen margins running even higher — up to 60–70% — in some high-value perishable categories, due to multiple layers of intermediaries between farm and consumer. Existing agritech platforms such as DeHaat and Ninjacart have digitized parts of this chain but have only partially solved the underlying economics. Propose a business model (not just a logistics app) that restructures value-chain economics — including farmer trust and adoption, cold-chain financing, and a path to unit-profitability that past agritech attempts have struggled to reach.

PS 3 — Cloud Kitchen Unit Economics

Thousands of cloud kitchens have shut down in the last three years as delivery platform commissions (typically 20–30% before GST and packaging costs) and heavy discounting eroded margins that were thin to begin with — the "low capex" pitch never translated into sustained profitability. Propose a food business model that is structurally profitable without depending on discount-driven platform volume — where pricing, channel mix (including direct ordering and lower-commission networks like ONDC), and cost structure are rethought, not the menu.

PS 4 — Diagnostic Healthcare in Tier 2/3 India

Organized diagnostic chains such as Dr Lal PathLabs and Metropolis remain concentrated in metro cities, even though roughly 85% of India's ~\$18 billion diagnostics market is still unorganized and Tier 2/3 demand is growing faster than metro demand. Low per-route test volumes and inconsistent payment realization leave smaller towns dependent on unregulated local labs of uneven accuracy. Design a business model that makes diagnostic services profitable at low volumes in smaller towns — solving the economics of collection, cold-chain sample transport, and pricing, not the lab technology itself.

PS 5 — Elder Care as an Organized Industry

India's 60+ population is projected to roughly double by 2050, and the traditional joint-family caregiving model is eroding fast in urban India, yet there is still no organized, trusted elder-care industry at scale — India's senior-care market is estimated at only around \$7 billion and remains dominated by hospitals and unorganized providers, unlike child care, which has organized players. Propose a sustainable business model for elder care in India — solving for the trust deficit of letting strangers into homes, affordability for middle-class families, and a viable revenue model beyond one-off nursing services.

PS 6 — EV Battery Second-Life Economics

India's EV battery packs typically retain 70–80% capacity when retired from vehicle use around year eight, still useful for stationary storage like solar backup, but there is no organized market to capture this value — batteries mostly go straight to recyclers or informal dismantlers who under-price the residual capacity. Propose a business model to aggregate, test, and resell or repurpose retired EV batteries — solving for battery health verification, liability if a repurposed battery fails, and who actually wants to buy "used" batteries.

PS 7 — E-Waste Recommerce and Buyback

India generates close to 1.75 million tonnes of e-waste annually, and while officially reported formal processing has risen in recent years, informal recyclers — including kabadiwalas — still handle the large majority of volumes, largely because there's no strong economic incentive for consumers to return old electronics through proper channels instead. Design a recommerce/buyback model profitable enough to outcompete the informal (kabadiwala) market on price, while still being sustainable for the collector — the incentive economics is the core problem, not the collection app.

PS 8 — Blood & Plasma Supply Chain

India faces a chronic blood shortage — the WHO recommends that around 1% of a population donate blood, and India sits at roughly 0.8%, leaving an annual shortfall of a few million units — not from a lack of willing donors but because voluntary donation drives, collection logistics, and cold-chain storage have no sustainable funding model; blood banks largely run as loss-making NGO/hospital appendages. Propose a business/financing model that makes the collection-to-hospital supply chain self-sustaining without commercializing blood itself (which is illegal in India) — the constraint is regulatory and economic, not medical.

PS 9 — Organized Funeral & Last-Rites Services

Death care in India is entirely unorganized and largely taboo to discuss commercially — families in grief pay unpredictable, often inflated prices to local priests, cremation ground operators, and ritual-item vendors with zero transparency, and there is no organized player, unlike the US, where death care is a formal industry generating over \$20 billion annually. Propose a respectful, culturally-appropriate business model for organizing this industry — the challenge is monetizing a moment where price-sensitivity and dignity are both non-negotiable.